

TEACHER'S VERSION — answers, model answers and teaching notes are printed in red.

PART A: PROOFREADING (10 SENTENCES)

Proofread the following sentences. Each sentence contains TWO errors.

1. In recent years, food delivery apps has become an indispensable part of daily life for busy office workers.
2. Living in a fast-pace society, commuters is constantly exposed to noise pollution.
3. In recent time, the issue of ageing population has spark widespread concern across society.
4. It is undeniable that early childhood education play a pivotal role in shape children's characters.
5. To begin with, cultural exchange programme offer students golden opportunity to broaden their horizon.
6. Furthermore, joining the school choir offer teenagers a valuable change to make new friends, which in turn boost their confidence.
7. From the perspective of parents, school counselling services allow it to understand their children better, which in turn strengthen family relationships.
8. School libraries serve as a powerful mean of encourage students to read, which enables them to become lifelong learners.
9. Admittedly, e-books are more convenience; nevertheless, printed books remain irreplaceable, as reading on paper help readers to concentrate better.
10. It is undeniable that a balanced diet play a pivotal role in maintaining student's health.

TEACHER'S ANSWERS (LESSON 3, PART A)

Item	Corrected sentence	The TWO errors and why
1	In recent years, food delivery apps have become an indispensable part of daily life for busy office workers.	(a) Agreement: "apps has" → "apps have" (plural subject). (b) Verb form: "has became" → "have become" — after "have" the past participle is needed. (Lesson 1, Pattern 1)
2	Living in a fast-paced society, commuters are constantly exposed to noise pollution.	(a) Part of speech: "fast-pace" → "fast-paced" (a compound adjective modifies "society") (b) Agreement: "commuters is" → "commuters are". (Lesson 1, Pattern 2)
3	In recent times, the issue of the ageing population has sparked widespread concern across society.	(a) Plural: "In recent time" → "In recent times" (the fixed pattern uses the plural). (b) Verb form: "has spark" → "has sparked" — the base form after "has" leaves the clause without a verb. (c) Also: "ageing population" → "the ageing population" (article). (Lesson 1, Pattern 3)

4	It is undeniable that early childhood education plays a pivotal role in shaping children's characters.	(a) Agreement: "education play" → "education plays". (b) Verb form: "in shape" → "in shaping" — a gerund is needed after the preposition "in". (Lesson 1, Pattern 4)
5	To begin with, cultural exchange programmes offer students a golden opportunity to broaden their horizons.	(a) Agreement: "programme offer" → "programmes offer" (also accepted: "a cultural exchange programme offers"). (b) Article: "students golden opportunity" → "students a golden opportunity". (c) Also: "their horizon" → "their horizons". (Lesson 2, Pattern 1)
6	Furthermore, joining the school choir offers teenagers a valuable chance to make new friends, which in turn boosts their confidence.	(a) Agreement: "choir offer" → "choir offers" (the subject is the gerund phrase "joining the school choir"). (b) Word choice: "a valuable change" → "a valuable chance". (c) Also: "which in turn boost" → "boosts" (the clause refers to the whole idea). (Lesson 2, Patterns 1 and 2)
7	From the perspective of parents, school counselling services allow them to understand their children better, which in turn strengthens family relationships.	(a) Pronoun reference: "allow it to understand" → "allow them to understand" (the parents). (b) Verb form: "which in turn strengthen" → "strengthens" — the clause needs a finite verb. (Lesson 2, Pattern 2)
8	School libraries serve as a powerful means of encouraging students to read, which enables them to become lifelong learners.	(a) Word form: "a powerful mean" → "a powerful means" (the fixed pattern). (b) Verb form: "of encourage" → "of encouraging" — a gerund is needed after the preposition "of". (Lesson 2, Pattern 3)
9	Admittedly, e-books are more convenient; nevertheless, printed books remain irreplaceable, as reading on paper helps readers to concentrate better.	(a) Part of speech: "more convenience" → "more convenient" (an adjective is needed after "are"). (b) Agreement: "reading ... help" → "helps" (the subject is the singular gerund "reading"). Note: the semicolon before "nevertheless" is correct — a comma would be a comma splice. (Lesson 2, Pattern 4)
10	It is undeniable that a balanced diet plays a pivotal role in maintaining students' health.	(a) Agreement: "diet play" → "diet plays". (b) Possessive / plural: "student's health" → "students' health" (all the students). (Lesson 1, Pattern 4)

PART B: UPGRADING SENTENCES — MAKING SUGGESTIONS

In the paragraph that suggests solutions, most students write **“Schools can ...”, “The government can ...” and “Parents can ...”**. These sentences are correct, but they are plain. Part B gives you THREE patterns that upgrade exactly these sentences.

Topic for this part: boost the physical fitness and awareness of citizens

LEVEL 3 — THE BASIC SENTENCES STUDENTS USUALLY WRITE

The government can build more sports facilities.

Schools can organise more sports activities and sports days.

Parents can exercise with their children at weekends.

Pattern 1 — Calling for Immediate Action

Target Formula: There is an urgent need for [doer] to [base verb phrase].

Level 3:	The government can build more sports facilities.
Level 5:	There is an urgent need for the government to invest in free, accessible sports facilities in every district.

Teaching note: “There is an urgent need for” is followed by [doer] + TO + base verb — never the base verb on its own (“for the government invest”) or a gerund (“for the government investing”). Use it when the problem cannot wait; “pressing” and “growing” can replace “urgent”.

Pattern 2 — Purpose-First Recommendation

Target Formula: To [goal], [doer] should make it a priority to [base verb phrase].

Level 3:	Schools can organise more sports activities and sports days.
Level 5:	To boost students’ physical fitness, schools should make it a priority to add a daily exercise break to the timetable.

Teaching note: “make it a priority to” takes the BASE verb (“to add”, never “to adding”). Opening with “To + goal” replaces the vague “so that” and shows the marker your purpose in the first three words.

Pattern 3 — Shared Responsibility

Target Formula: [Doer], in collaboration with [second party], should [verb phrase].

Level 3:	Parents can exercise with their children at weekends.
Level 5:	Parents, in collaboration with schools, should encourage their children to adopt a more active lifestyle.

Teaching note: “in collaboration with” = working together with. It is far stronger than “and” or “also” and shows the marker that you understand shared responsibility. The doer is swappable: “The government, in collaboration with district councils, should ...”.

Teacher’s note on the design: the three patterns are deliberately kept to ONE clause. Endings of the “, so as to ...” / “, thereby + -ing” type were left out this time — level 3 students lose control of the main clause as soon as they open a second one. Add the endings back only when the class can hold the short form.

LEVEL 3 → LEVEL 5 VOCABULARY (physical fitness and awareness)

#	Level 3 (what students write)	Level 5 upgrade (key words in bold)
1	make people healthier	enhance citizens' physical well-being <i>e.g. Regular exercise enhances citizens' physical well-being.</i>
2	tell people about the importance of exercise	raise public awareness of the importance of regular exercise <i>e.g. A city-wide campaign would raise public awareness of the importance of regular exercise.</i>
3	do exercise	take regular exercise / adopt an active lifestyle <i>e.g. Citizens who take regular exercise are far less likely to fall ill.</i>
4	build more sports places	provide accessible sports facilities <i>e.g. Accessible sports facilities encourage even the busiest workers to exercise.</i>
5	stop people from being lazy	combat sedentary lifestyles <i>e.g. A morning workout scheme can combat sedentary lifestyles among office workers.</i>

PART C: PRACTICE SETS (6 SETS)

Upgrade each simple sentence with the pattern shown, and keep the pattern to ONE clause, as taught in Part B. The topics are different from the fitness topic in Part B. Sets 4–6 are more challenging: you must join the TWO simple sentences into ONE upgraded sentence.

Set 1. Topic: Teenage Sleep Deprivation

Simple sentence	The government can tell teenagers about the importance of sleep.
Use Pattern 1	There is an urgent need for the government to raise teenagers' awareness of the importance of sleep.

Key note: Accept any sensible base verb phrase: “launch a campaign on healthy sleeping habits”, “make sleep education part of the junior curriculum”.

Set 2. Topic: Food Waste on Campus

Simple sentence	Schools can ask students not to waste food in the canteen.
Use Pattern 2	To cut food waste on campus, schools should make it a priority to offer smaller portions and free second helpings.

Key note: Accept “To reduce food waste ...” and any sensible verb phrase after “make it a priority to”.

Set 3. Topic: Cyberbullying

Simple sentence	Parents can talk to their children about cyberbullying.
Use Pattern 3	Parents, in collaboration with schools, should discuss online safety openly with their children.

Key note: Accept any sensible second party (the school, social workers) and any formal verb phrase (“set clear rules about online behaviour at home”).

Set 4. Topic: Youth Mental Health (more challenging)

Simple sentences	The government can spend more money on mental health services.
	Young people need these services at school.
Use Pattern 1	There is an urgent need for the government to invest more in school-based mental health services for young people.

Key note: Idea 2 is folded into the modifier “school-based”, so the pattern stays one clean clause. Also accept “... invested more in mental health services in schools.”

Set 5. Topic: Declining Reading Habits (more challenging)

Simple sentences	Schools can keep the library open after school.
	Students need a quiet place to read.
Use Pattern 2	To give students a quiet place to read, schools should make it a priority to keep the library open after school.

Key note: Idea 2 becomes the fronted goal; the second plain sentence must disappear into the pattern.

Set 6. Topic: Care for the Elderly (more challenging)

Simple sentences	Teenagers can visit elderly neighbours who live alone.
	Community centres can arrange these visits.
Use Pattern 3	Teenagers, in collaboration with community centres, should organise regular visits to elderly neighbours who live alone.

Key note: Idea 2 becomes the second party after “in collaboration with”. Watch the plural: “the elderly” is already plural — never “the elderlies”.

PART D: WRITING PRACTICE

HKDSE Adapted Paper 2 Prompt: You are a Form 6 student. Hong Kong’s population is ageing rapidly, and the needs of elderly citizens have become a pressing social issue. Write a letter to the editor of the Hong Kong Young Post, suggesting THREE ways in which our city can care for its growing number of elderly citizens.
--

Task requirements:

Write THREE body paragraphs (about 100 words each) for this letter.

Begin each paragraph with a topic sentence that makes ONE suggestion, using a different pattern from today’s lesson in each paragraph.

Then explain why the suggestion helps, give an example or some evidence, and round the paragraph off.

You do NOT need to use the Lesson 1 or Lesson 2 patterns in the explanation, the example or the round-off.

Follow the chain: [Topic sentence] → [Explain] → [Example / evidence] → [Round off].

Teacher’s three suggested paragraphs (the body of the letter — the opening “Dear Editor,” and the closing are the class’s own work)

Suggested paragraph 1 — community health care (Pattern 1)

There is an urgent need for the government to invest in community health services for the elderly. [Topic sentence — Pattern 1] Many older citizens find a trip to a

hospital exhausting, and a minor complaint that nobody checks in time easily grows into a serious illness that could have been prevented. [Explain]Take an elderly resident with high blood pressure: a fortnightly visit from a community nurse would keep the condition under control, while an appointment at a public hospital may not come for months. [Example]Looking after the elderly in their own neighbourhood therefore protects both their health and the public purse that pays for their treatment. [Round off]

Suggested paragraph 2 — community centres against loneliness (Pattern 2)

To ease the loneliness that many elderly people face, district councils should make it a priority to turn community centres into lively daily meeting places. [Topic sentence — Pattern 2]Isolation damages both the mind and the body, and it is far cheaper to prevent than to treat with medicine. [Explain]A centre that runs morning tai chi and afternoon board games, for instance, gives a retired resident a fixed routine, a reason to leave the flat and the friendships that come with it. [Example]Simple, cheap and human, these centres are the best medicine our city can offer its older residents. [Round off]

Suggested paragraph 3 — work and purpose for retired citizens (Pattern 3)

The government, in collaboration with businesses and charities, should create flexible part-time jobs for retired workers. [Topic sentence — Pattern 3]Many experienced citizens still have energy and skills to offer, yet they are pushed out of the workforce the moment they turn sixty-five, which leaves both the economy and their own sense of purpose the poorer. [Explain]A retired accountant could mentor young clerks two mornings a week, or a former nurse could advise a care home part-time, with the government covering part of the wage. [Example]Giving older citizens a role keeps their skills alive and lightens the welfare burden on the younger generation. [Round off]

Teacher's note: check every paragraph against the chain [Topic sentence] → [Explain] → [Example / evidence] → [Round off]. The topic sentence is the only place where a target pattern is required.

What to reward when marking

Content: three DIFFERENT suggestions that are realistic for Hong Kong, each with its own paragraph — not three versions of the same idea.

Language: the topic sentence uses the target pattern accurately; the explanation, the example and the round-off may be in the students' own plain English.

Organisation: one suggestion per paragraph, each following [Topic sentence] → [Explain] → [Example / evidence] → [Round off].

Common errors to watch when marking

"There is an urgent need for the government invest ..." → the infinitive is needed ("to invest").

"make it a priority to + -ing" → base verb only ("to add").

"in collaboration with" used as a verb ("parents collaborate with schools should...") → keep it as a phrase between the subject and the modal.

Sentence boundaries: a participle phrase after a comma with no matching subject ("Living in a fast-paced society, academic pressure ..."), or a new sentence after a comma ("... flexibility, nevertheless, they cannot ...") → full stop and a capital letter.

"the elderly" treated as singular ("the elderlies", "the elderly feels").